

"Daily Digest" — A Personal Triage Tool

What you're building

A tool that produces a personalized morning digest for one person, "Avery Chen" — a founder of a 12-person startup. Avery has three information sources.

You should create these synthetic data sources with diverse distribution.

1. Inbox — ~500 synthetic emails over 30 days
2. Calendar — a synthetic `.ics` file with 30 days of meetings, declines, blocks
3. Notes — a directory of 10 markdown notes (meeting notes, drafts, todos) from the company meetings
4. Tasks — a list of 5 tasks Avery has to undertake

The system has a default format of the daily digest given below.

Given in the appendix is `profile.md` describing who Avery is, what they care about, who matters to them.

Create a tool that produces a one-page digest that:

1. Highlights what genuinely matters today
2. Surfaces what Avery might be missing (forgotten threads, declined meetings, stale follow-ups, contradictions between sources)
3. Drafts replies or task items for anything dispatchable in under a minute
4. Is honest when sources are stale, missing, or contradictory — no fabricated certainty
5. Takes an option of `-customize=prompt.md` where it customizes the digest if the prompt is provided. If the option is not provided, the default format is produced.
6. Provide a design for running this tool on a schedule of choice. You do not have to implement it, but explain your options on design and recommended approach.

The bounds

- You can use any AI tool you want, we will love to see your sessions.
- You can choose the interface for request/response (CLI, web, Slack, email).
- You choose the LLM, harness, prompting strategy, persistence, architecture, and language. You can use `claude/codex/gemini` CLI to simulate the work. If you want to do programmatic work, need we can give you a OpenRouter API key with a small budget.

What you show us

1. A private repo with working code and synthetic data sets, shared with us
2. A 1-page README — how to install and run it against the dataset
3. A 1-page design doc explaining: what you built, what you considered and rejected, and what you'd do with a second week
4. A walkthrough meeting after you are done.

What we're not looking for

- A finished product
- A beautiful UI
- A 12-screen architecture diagram

We want to see how you think, build, and use AI under a real constraint.

Anti-patterns to avoid (these *will* hurt your grade)

- Letting the AI pick your architecture without you having an opinion
- No way to tell whether your digest is actually good
- Spending the week on the UI while the engine stays thin
- Not being able to defend your choices against pushback

None

Avery Chen – Profile

> This is the profile file the digest tool reads. Written in my voice. If something here
> contradicts what the data shows, trust the data and flag the contradiction.

Who I am

I'm Avery Chen, co-founder and CEO of Tesseract, a 12-person B2B SaaS company doing supply-chain visibility for mid-market manufacturers. I'm 37. I live in Oakland with my partner Sam and our 4-year-old, Wren. This is my second company; the first one sold to a logistics incumbent in 2020 for not very much.

We're at ~\$3.2M ARR, raised a \$6M seed 14 months ago, and I'm in the early phase of a Series A raise. Runway is okay but not comfortable. I think about it every day.

What a great morning digest looks like to me

A great digest answers three questions in under 90 seconds of reading:

1. **What needs me today?** Not what's interesting. Not what's new. What requires *my* judgment, *my* signature, *my* reply, before end of day.
2. **What am I about to drop?** Threads that have gone quiet on my end. Calendar conflicts I haven't resolved. Decisions I deferred and forgot.
3. **What can I dispatch right now?** Replies under 3 sentences. Quick yes/no approvals. Calendar accepts/declines. Drafts you can write *for* me and I just send.

A bad digest tells me about my own calendar like I haven't seen it, summarizes threads I just sent, or pretends a marketing newsletter is news.

How I work

- I read email between 6:15-6:45am, then 12:30-1pm, then once after Wren is asleep. Anything that arrives outside those windows can wait.
- I batch reply. I almost never reply in real time.

- I write short. Three sentences is normal. Two is fine. One is great.
- I'm warm to people I trust and curt to people I don't, and I don't apologize for this. If a draft you write for me sounds effusive or chirpy, it's wrong.
- I block 9-11am Tue/Thu for deep work. Anyone scheduling over that block without asking is doing something wrong, and I want to know.

People who matter

These names show up in the data. The signal level next to each is how much weight to give *anything* from them by default. Override based on content.

- ****Sam Park**** (partner) – anything from Sam is P0. Personal.
- ****Priya Iyer**** (co-founder, CTO) – P0. We talk constantly. If she emails instead of slacks, it's intentional and important.
- ****Marcus Webb**** (Series A lead at Inflection Point Ventures) – P0 during the raise. I do not miss replies to Marcus.
- ****Diane Okafor**** (board member, prior seed lead) – P1. She's patient but I owe her quarterly updates and don't always send them.
- ****Jordan Liu**** (Head of Eng) – P1. He escalates rarely; when he does, listen.
- ****Tomás Reyes**** (Head of GTM) – P1. He emails too much. Look for the one thing that actually matters in each thread.
- ****Ben Schaffer**** (lawyer, Wilson Sonsini) – P0 during the raise, P2 otherwise.
- ****The procurement leads at Halberd Manufacturing, Northstar Foods, and Veritas Components**** – our three reference customers. Anything from them is P1 and gets a same-day reply, period.
- ****Recruiters cold-emailing me**** – P4. Don't draft replies. Don't surface them unless three+ from the same firm in a week, then surface as a pattern, not as individual threads.

What I don't want surfaced

- Newsletters. Even the good ones. Even Stratechery. I'll read them when I want to.
- Calendar invites I already accepted. I don't need a reminder that I have a meeting at 2pm; my calendar app does that.
- Marketing emails from SaaS tools, even ones we pay for.
- Long threads where I've already had the last word and nobody else has replied.
- Anything where the only "action" is "FYI."

What I might miss without help

- Quiet investor threads. If Marcus or another VC went quiet, I want to know after three business days, not three weeks.
- Customer health signals buried in support threads. If Halberd's procurement lead is suddenly quieter, that's a flag.
- Calendar collisions involving Wren's daycare, doctor appointments, or anything Sam put on our shared calendar. Family first. Always.
- Promises I made in email and didn't put on a todo list. "I'll send that by Friday" hiding in a Tuesday thread.
- Hiring loops that have stalled. We're hiring two engineers and a designer; if a candidate is mid-loop and nobody has moved them in 5+ days, that's on me.

Tone for drafted replies

- Short. Lowercase greetings or none at all. Sign off with "Avery" or nothing.

- No "I hope this email finds you well." No "circling back." No "just wanted to."
- Direct but not cold. Warmth comes from specificity, not adjectives. "Thanks for the rev share on Halberd, that's the thing I wanted" beats "Thanks so much!!"
- For investors during the raise, slightly more polished. Still short.
- For Sam: don't draft. Surface and let me write.

Things you should be honest about

- If the inbox data is older than 24 hours, say so.
- If you can't tell whether a thread is urgent, say "I'm not sure" and show me the thread.
- If you drafted a reply based on assumptions, flag the assumptions.
- If two sources disagree (e.g., calendar says I'm meeting Marcus Friday but email says we moved to Monday), tell me – don't pick one and hide it.

What "today" means

Pacific time. My day starts at 6am. The digest runs at 6:00am sharp. "Today" in the digest means today's calendar plus anything that needs a reply before midnight Pacific.

None

Sample Daily Digest – Thursday, May 21, 2026

Current Timezone: America/Los_Angeles.

If there is one thing you must do right now:

****Send the updated cap table to Marcus Webb before 11:00am.**** You promised Tuesday night ("tonight"), it's now Thursday morning, and the Series A term sheet conversation is paused on this. Ben Schaffer has the latest version – confirm it's the one he sent Monday, then forward to Marcus. This is the second slip on the same commitment to your lead investor. *[email: Marcus, May 19 16:42] [email: Ben, May 18 09:11]*

Urgent To-Do Today

- ****Reply to Renee Tan at Halberd Manufacturing.**** She's asking whether the May 28 rollout is still on. Their internal stakeholder meeting is tomorrow morning; she needs an answer by EOD. Jordan confirmed Tuesday that engineering is on track – answer is yes. *[email: Renee, May 20 14:08]*
- ****Sign Mei Tanaka's offer letter.**** Tomás and Jordan both signed off Monday. The letter has been sitting in DocuSign for 48 hours. Mei's competing offer expires Friday per her last email. *[email: Tomás, May 19 18:22]*
- ****Send Diane Okafor the Q1 board update.**** It's 11 days overdue – last update sent Feb 8. She hasn't asked yet, but the cadence was your commitment. *[note: board-update-cadence.md]*

- **Reply to David Kim at Aperture Capital.** Thread has been quiet for 21 days during an active raise. You owned the next step ("let's talk soon," Apr 30). *[email: David, Apr 30 11:15]*

Decisions & Approvals Needed

- **Lumen Analytics demo at 10:30am** – the rep is waiting on agenda choice: standard demo or API-focused walkthrough. Your team's evaluation hinges on ingestion + backfill behavior; recommend API-focused. *[email: Lumen, May 20 17:31]*

- **Q2 planning doc has two open comments** from Jordan and Priya, both submitted Tuesday/Wednesday. You're the doc owner and the 2:30pm planning sync is the artifact review. *[note: q2-planning.md]*

- **Three expense reports awaiting your finance approval** – submitted Monday, blocking team payouts. Small task, easy to drop. *[email: Finance, May 19 10:04]*

- **Northstar Foods thread forwarded by Tomás with "thoughts?" and no context** – 14 messages long, could be billing, renewal signal, or escalation. You need to open it to decide; I couldn't rank it without reading. *[email: Tomás fwd, May 20 22:11]*

AI Industry News

- **OpenRouter announced volume pricing on DeepSeek-V4 Pro, ~30% lower, effective June 1.** Directly relevant to the inference-cost line item in your Series A model. Worth a 10-minute re-run before Marcus's diligence call. *[source: OpenRouter blog, May 20]*

- **Two of your reference customers (Halberd, Northstar) attended last week's MX Manufacturing AI Summit.** Both presented case studies that did not name Tessera. Could be MSA constraint, could be a positioning miss. Worth asking Renee casually when you reply to her above. *[source: MX Summit public agenda]*

- **New EU AI Act guidance on supply-chain data processors** dropped Tuesday. Applies to vendors handling production-line telemetry from EU manufacturers. Not blocking today; will matter when Tessera sells into Bosch's tier-2 ecosystem next year. *[source: EU Commission Q2 guidance, May 19]*

Team & Product Pulse

- **Sprint status:** Halberd rollout on track for May 28. Two minor regressions opened by QA yesterday, neither blocking – Jordan's standup notes confirm. *[note: sprint-may-week3.md]*

- **Customer signal – Northstar Foods:** their procurement lead's reply cadence has slowed from 1.2 days to 4.8 days over the last two weeks. No support tickets open. Could be normal noise; could be early churn signal. Flagging as a pattern, not an action. *[email: thread digest, Northstar]*

- **Customer signal – Veritas Components:** their CFO pushed the renewal conversation to "next quarter" last Thursday. Tomás logged it Tuesday but didn't escalate. This is the second time Veritas has moved a renewal date. *[note: customer-veritas-renewal.md]*

- **Hiring:** Mei (blocked on your offer signing, above). Designer loop has been stalled 7 days with no candidate movement since last Thursday – Tomás owns next step. *[note: hiring-status.md]*

Calendar & Personal

- **09:00** - 1:1 with Jordan (30m)
- **10:30** - Lumen Analytics demo (45m) - *agenda choice required above*
- **13:00** - Lunch block (held)
- **14:30** - Q2 planning sync (60m)
- **16:00** - Backend candidate interview (45m)

****Possible conflict - heads up.**** Sam added "Wren - pediatrician 3:00pm" to the shared calendar at 21:04 last night. It overlaps your 2:30 Q2 planning sync and runs into your 4:00 interview prep window. I don't know whether Sam expects you to take Wren or just to be aware. Worth a one-line text to Sam this morning before anything else moves. *[cal: shared, added May 20 21:04]*